I have a text that contains TEI tags. I also have that same text with slight changes to the spelling of some words, without the TEI tags. Are you able to transfer the changes in the second text to the first one, without affecting the TEI tags?

Yes — I can do that.

What you're describing is essentially **merging textual variants while preserving markup**, which is a very common TEI workflow (similar to aligning witnesses or updating normalized spellings without breaking XML structure).

Here's how it works on my end:

✅ I will:

- keep **all TEI tags exactly as they are** (structure, attributes, spacing, hierarchy)
- compare the **plain-text version** against the TEI-encoded version
- transfer only the **spelling changes / textual differences**
- leave tags, entities, and encoding untouched
- preserve valid XML/TEI structure

🚫 I will not:

- rewrite or reorganize tags unless you explicitly ask
- normalize beyond the differences present in your second text
- alter attributes or metadata

What I need from you

Please provide:

1. **The TEI version** (with tags)
2. **The modified plain-text version** (without tags)

You can paste them directly here. If they're long, you can send them in multiple messages — just label them clearly, e.g.:

```
TEI TEXT — PART 1
...
```

```
PLAIN TEXT — PART 1
...
```

Optional (but helpful)

Tell me if any of these apply:

- Do spelling changes ever cross tag boundaries? (e.g., word split by `<hi>` or `<lb/>`)
- Should punctuation differences also be transferred?
- Should capitalization changes be applied?

Once you send the texts, I'll produce a **TEI-safe updated version** with the spelling changes applied.

Great! Would you also be able to generate a list of the changes made?

Yes — I can absolutely do that as well.

When I transfer the changes, I can also produce a **change log** alongside the updated TEI text.

✅ What the change list can include

I can generate a structured record such as:

- original spelling (from the TEI text)
- updated spelling (from the plain-text version)
- surrounding context (optional but recommended)
- location indicator (e.g., line number, nearby text, or XML element)

- type of change (spelling, capitalization, punctuation, etc.)

Example output (illustrative)

Updated TEI (excerpt)

```xml
<p>Il avoit grant desir de veoir le roi.</p>
```

Change log

#	Original	Updated	Context	Element
1	avoit	avait	Il ___ grant desir	<p>
2	veoir	voir	desir de ___ le roi	<p>

Alternative formats (your choice)

I can format the change list as:

- ✅ table (easy to read)
- ✅ CSV (for Excel or analysis)
- ✅ TEI `<listChange>` or `<app>/<rdg>` style
- ✅ plain bullet list
- ✅ diff-style output (like Git)

Just tell me which you prefer.

Whenever you're ready, send:

1. **TEI text**
2. **Modified plain text**
3. (optional) preferred change-log format

I'll return:

- the **updated TEI document**
- the **complete list of changes made**.

There are many diacritics and combining characters inboth the TEI and plaintext transcriptions - will these be an issue?

Good question — and this is **exactly** the kind of thing that *can* cause problems in automated comparison, but it's manageable if handled correctly.

Short answer: **No, it won't be an issue** — I can safely handle diacritics and combining characters — but I will process them carefully using Unicode-aware comparison.

Why diacritics can be tricky

Two strings that *look identical* may actually be different internally in Unicode.

For example:

- **é** can be encoded as:
  - single character: `U+00E9` (precomposed)
  - or: `e + U+0301` (combining acute accent)

Visually identical → technically different bytes.

This affects:

- medieval/transcription texts
- TEI diplomatic editions
- combining macrons, breves, tildes, superscripts, etc.

A naïve diff would falsely report many changes.

How I will handle it safely

I will use a **Unicode-normalization-aware comparison**, meaning:

✅ Normalize both texts before comparison (internally only)

- typically NFC or NFD normalization
- preserves visual equivalence

✅ Compare *grapheme clusters* (what readers perceive as characters), not raw codepoints.

✅ Apply spelling changes back onto the **original TEI text**, preserving:

- original encoding form
- combining marks
- entity references
- tag boundaries

So your TEI remains valid and faithful.

What will NOT change

- Existing diacritic usage in TEI will stay unless the plaintext explicitly changes it.
- Combining characters will not be reordered or simplified unintentionally.
- XML entities like `é` or `̄` will remain intact.

One thing that helps (optional)

If you know, tell me:

- Are both files exported from the **same editor/tool**?
- Do you want normalization differences themselves reported as changes?

You can choose:

- **Strict mode** → report every Unicode difference
- **Visual mode (recommended)** → only meaningful spelling changes reported

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When you're ready, send the texts — diacritics and all.
I'll handle the alignment and produce both the updated TEI and a clean change log without Unicode noise.